

# KONSTANTIN ROKOSSOVSKY TOP 3 LEGENDARY TACTICAL MOVES

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video



Main thumbnail: IMPASSABLE (battlefield made with vidIQ;  
Rokossovsky's real public-domain 1945 photo added on top)

# 1. The finished video

| Item          | Details                                                                                                              |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| File          | Rokossovsky-Top3-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC, 1097 MB)                                                 |
| Download      | (not uploaded: Gofile unreachable from the cloud machine; master is build/rokovossovsky.mp4 on the session machine)  |
| Length        | 15:36                                                                                                                |
| Voice         | Voice A: Kokoro am_michael converted to the owner's voice (reference: the approved voice-A sample, see note in chat) |
| Music         | Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks, CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice (locked level 0.08)                                       |
| Sound effects | The channel's locked kit: Freesound recordings (CC BY / CC0), Mixkit sounds, original effects                        |

## Chapters

| Starts | Chapter                                       |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 0:00   | Intro: The Swamps No Army Could Cross         |
| 2:39   | Move 1: The Volokolamsk Highway (Moscow 1941) |
| 7:01   | Move 2: The Northern Face of Kursk (1943)     |
| 11:04  | Move 3: Operation Bagration (1944)            |
| 15:08  | Legacy                                        |

## Key frames (the hook)

# HOOK (hook-1.3) · Rokossovsky #8 · bobruisk map

mm:ss = time in the video; option 1 = territory colours (wide), option 2 = glowing two-colour front lines (close-up)



hook-1 FIRST FRAME: Belarus Jun 44 (option 1), units already on the map, blue cavalry/tanks/infantry start moving none (narration starts)



IMPASSABLE stamp slams onto the marsh; German belief caption hit



log roads drawn across the bog; tanks, cavalry, infantry slide into the swamp ref:whoosh, ref:pop



ALERT rings on the thin German screen, too late; MG fire, impacts (shake) mg, impact



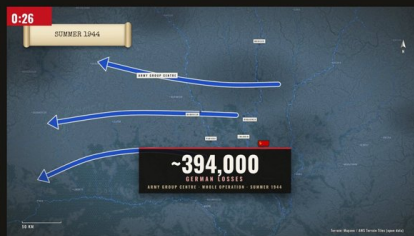
hook-2 WHITE-FLASH cut into the flash-forward: 27 JUNE 1944 whoosh (zoom) - hit



two arrows close the ring at Bobruisk (option 2 glow ring: TRAPPED ref:boom, hit



zoom out: German ground collapses (22 Jun - 4 Jul), German flag on the remaining western strip, arrows sweep west whoosh (zoom)



counter ticking to ~400,000 GERMAN LOSSES (whole operation) tick x n, hit



ARMY GROUP CENTRE struck through (one of the worst defeats) hit



hook-3 dark map: Rokossovsky badge (licensed photo) behind prison bars, AUG 1937 - MAR 1940 ticker hit, ticks



ARRESTED stamp: 'by his family's account' rows appear hit, ref:pop



NEVER SIGNED A FALSE CONFESSION stamp hit

## 2. Title and thumbnail

### Title (locked, vidIQ score 93)

Rokossovsky's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Destroyed Hitler's Strongest Army

Alternatives (vidIQ scores):

- Rokossovsky's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Broke Army Group Centre (89)
- Rokossovsky's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The General Better Than Zhukov (87)

### Why this thumbnail

Tactical Genius picture formula: a dark aerial battlefield with red/blue unit blocks and white arrows on the left, the commander on the right, a red brush banner bottom-left. **IMPASSABLE** is type 3 (ominous stakes): the Germans' belief about the Belarus swamps, the same promise as the hook and the title (the swamps no army could cross, Army Group Centre destroyed). No quote marks: it is not a verbatim quote.

Alternative for YouTube's Test & compare: **TWO BLOWS** (type 1, his decision against Stalin).



Checked: Bobruisk and Parichi labels (the AI image's own labels were removed: it had Parichi in the wrong place), swamp, log road and birch forest match Belarus 1944. The portrait is Rokossovsky's real 1945 photo (public domain), not an AI likeness; it shows him as a Marshal (he was made Marshal on 29 June 1944, during the battle).

**Before uploading:** check the thumbnail at small size on a phone.

### 3. Description (copy and paste)

The first line is the title. Everything after it is the description: ready to paste, with NO links (channel rule). Keep the credit lines: the music, sound, archive and image licences require them.

Rokossovsky's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Destroyed Hitler's Strongest Army

The Germans were certain that no army could cross the swamps of Belarus. In June 1944, one Soviet general sent tanks, cavalry and infantry straight through them, and within weeks Army Group Centre had lost around 400,000 men.

Konstantin Rokossovsky went from a Soviet prison cell to three of the greatest battles of the Second World War. In this video we break down his three greatest tactical moves: the elastic defence of the Volokolamsk highway before Moscow in 1941, the defence of the northern face of the Kursk salient at Ponyri and Olkhovatka in 1943, and the two-pronged breakthrough at Bobruisk during Operation Bagration in 1944.

Bend, don't break. Read the blow before it lands. Strike where the map says you can't.

Which commander should we cover next? Let us know in the comments.

#### CHAPTERS

0:00 Intro: The Swamps No Army Could Cross  
1:46 Hitler Invades; the Road to Moscow  
2:39 Move 1: The Volokolamsk Highway (Moscow 1941)  
4:55 The Istra Reservoir: Rokossovsky vs Zhukov  
6:07 The Counter-Attack  
7:01 Move 2: The Northern Face of Kursk (1943)  
8:41 Firing First: the Counter-Barrage  
9:32 The Fight for Ponyri  
11:04 Move 3: Operation Bagration (1944)  
11:54 "Go and Think It Over": Two Blows  
12:43 Out of the Marshes: Bobruisk  
14:32 57,000 Prisoners in Moscow  
15:08 Legacy

#### SOURCES

Konstantin Rokossovsky, *A Soldier's Duty* (memoirs, Progress Publishers)  
David M. Glantz & Jonathan M. House, *When Titans Clashed: How the Red Army Stopped Hitler* (1995)  
Boris Sokolov, Marshal K. K. Rokossovsky: The Red Army's Gentleman Commander (Helion)  
Robert Forczyk, *Moscow 1941: Hitler's First Defeat* (Osprey, 2006)  
Karl-Heinz Frieser et al., *Germany and the Second World War, Vol. VIII* (Oxford University Press)  
G. F. Krivosheev (ed.), *Soviet Casualties and Combat Losses in the Twentieth Century* (1997)  
Niklas Zetterling & Anders Frankson, *Kursk 1943: A Statistical Analysis* (2000)

#### CREDITS

Maps: original animations. Terrain: Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data). Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL). Rivers and lakes on the overview map: Natural Earth (public domain). Historical borders: aourednik/historical-basemaps.

Music by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech.com): "Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish". Licensed under Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0.

Sound effects: "artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots" by Aegersum (CC BY 3.0), "Distant explosion" by juskiddink (CC BY 4.0), "Distant explosions" by Kostrava (CC0), via freesound.org. Aircraft and transition sounds: Mixkit (Mixkit Sound Effects Free License). Other sound effects: original.

#### Images:

- Bundesarchiv, Bild 101I-212-0212A-19, photographer: Koch, CC BY-SA 3.0 DE (Erich Hoepner)  
- Bundesarchiv, Bild 183-2005-1017-519, photographer: Fritz Lucke, CC BY-SA 3.0 DE (Walther Model)  
- Bundesarchiv, Bild 101I-088-3724-06A, photographer: Thiemann, CC BY-SA 3.0 DE (Ernst Busch)  
- Public domain: Soviet wartime photographs of K. Rokossovsky (Grigory Vayl), G. Zhukov (Grigory Vayl), M. Katukov (Arkady Khodov), I. Panfilov (Mikhail Kalashnikov), B. Shaposhnikov; national flags.  
Archive film: "The Battle of Russia" (1943, US Army Special Service Division) and Army-Navy Screen Magazine no. 47 (1944, US Army Signal Corps), US government works, public domain. Victory Parade photographs: mil.ru / Russian Ministry of Defence, licensed under Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 (one by Evgeny Khaldei).

Narration voice: AI-generated. Maps: original animations.

■ Business enquiries: [email to fill in]

#Rokossovsky #OperationBagration #MilitaryHistory

## 4. Upload settings

| Setting                      | Value                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tags                         | military history, ww2 documentary, eastern front, Konstantin Rokossovsky, Rokossovsky, Operation Bagration, Battle of Kursk, Battle of Moscow, Bobruisk, Ponyri, Army Group Centre, Georgy Zhukov, Walther Model, Red Army, animated battle map, greatest military tactics, ww2 animated history |
| Category                     | Education                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Audience                     | Not made for kids                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Language / captions          | English; let YouTube auto-caption, then check the names (Rokossovsky, Volokolamsk, Hoepner, Ponyri, Olkhovotka, Bobruisk, Bagration, Parichi, Rogachev, Shaposhnikov)                                                                                                                            |
| Altered or synthetic content | Yes: the narration is an AI voice and the thumbnail battlefield is AI-generated. Tick the disclosure box.                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Chapters                     | Automatic from the description (first chapter is 0:00)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Pinned comment               | Which commander should we cover next? Zhukov, Konev, Manstein, Model...?                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Schedule                     | Your audience's peak time (YouTube Studio > Analytics > Audience)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

### Upload checklist

- Play the 1080p master through once (sound, sync, no black frames).
- Upload the master.
- Paste title, description and tags; upload the thumbnail (1280x720).
- Fill in the business email in the description.
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'.
- Add end screen and cards; set visibility and schedule.
- After 24-48 h: check click-through rate and 30-second retention; if CTR is under 2% after ~1,000 impressions, switch to the alternative thumbnail.

**Facts to double-check before publishing** (single source, memoir-based or approximate; see research/FACT\_NOTES.md):

- The Istra-reservoir episode (Zhukov refused, Shaposhnikov approved, Zhukov cancelled) and the "two blows" meeting with Stalin both come from Rokossovsky's own memoirs; Zhukov disputed them (the script says so).
- Torture details: from the family's account (teeth, ribs, two mock executions), worded as such.
- Kryukovo / Istra retaken ~8 / ~11 December 1941 (map labels).
- German 9th Army losses at Kursk shown as ~20,000-23,000 (Frieser / Zetterling range).
- Bobruisk pocket ~50,000 killed and ~20,000 captured (Wikipedia, Bobruysk offensive); no reliable Soviet figure, shown as a dash.
- ~400,000 German losses = whole Operation Bagration (Frieser 399,102), stated as such.
- All front lines are approximate (logged per date in research/FACT\_NOTES\_\*.md).